

HEAT SURVIVAL GUIDE

Emergency Action Manual for Summer Heatwaves & Loo in Nepal

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1. The 35°C Wet-Bulb Danger Threshold

When air temperature exceeds 35°C with high humidity (wet-bulb temperature), sweat can no longer evaporate to cool the human body. Core internal body temperature begins climbing uncontrollably toward organ failure. Recognizing early symptoms: throbbing headache, dizziness, absence of sweating despite intense heat, confusion, and rapid pulse.

2. Cellular Hydration & Electrolyte Protocol

Drinking pure water in huge volumes during intense sweating flushes out essential sodium, triggering hyponatremia. Mandatory standard: Supplement every litre of water with Oral Rehydration Salts (ORS / Jeevan Jal) or a pinch of salt and lemon. Avoid caffeinated beverages, alcohol, and heavy sugary sodas which accelerate thermal dehydration.

3. Low-Cost Passive Home Cooling Architecture

Keep living spaces 5°C to 8°C cooler without AC: (1) Day Sealing: Close all eastern, southern, and western windows with thick or reflective curtains by 8:00 AM; (2) Night Flushing: Open opposite windows from 8:00 PM to 6:00 AM to flush out stored daytime heat; (3) Hang damp cotton bedsheets in front of fan drafts for DIY evaporative cooling.

4. Emergency First-Aid for Heatstroke Victims

Heatstroke is a medical emergency. Act immediately: (1) Move patient immediately into deepest shade; (2) Spray or sponge body continuously with cool (not ice cold) water while fanning vigorously; (3) Place ice packs or wet cloth packs on neck, armpits, and groin where major blood vessels run; (4) Transport immediately to nearest clinic.